tomato, chilli, mixed vegetables such as potato, carrot, beans, peas, cauliflower are used to prepare pickle.



▲ Plate 6.14 Lemon pickle



▲ Plate 6.15 Vadu Manga or Mangai pickle

I. Common Ingredients used for Pickling

a. Salt: Common salt is used for pickling. Salt should be free from lime (Ca CO_3) as it reduces the acidity of the vinegar in which brined vegetables are packed. Vegetables do not ferment when they are strongly brined by large quantity of salt. Spoilage of pickle is prevented by adding sufficient amount of common salt.

b. Vinegar: Vinegar acts as a preservative. To avoid dilution of the vinegar by the water liberated from the tissues, the vegetables are generally placed in strong vinegar of about 10 per cent acidity for several days before pickling.

c. Sugar: Sugar used in the preparation of sweet pickles should be of high quality. Sugar helps in the preservation of products in which it is used.

d. Spices: Spices are generally added to all the pickles but the quantity added depends upon the kind of fruit or vegetable taken and the kind of flavour desired. Spices generally used are cardamom, dry chillies, cinnamon, clove, coriander seeds, pepper, turmeric, mustard, cumin and fenugreek seeds. Condiments such as ginger, garlic, mint, curry leaves and asafoetida are used. Spices are used either in the fresh or in the dry powder form.

e. Water: Only potable water should be used for the preparation of brine. Hard water interferes with the normal salt curing of the vegetables.

f. Colouring and Hardening Agent: Natural colouring agent, turmeric is commonly used in pickles, sauces and ketch ups. Artificial colours are not generally added to pickle, although used at permissible limits. Alum is sometimes used to give firmness to the vegetables used for pickling.

II. Types of Pickles

There are five types of pickles.

a) Salt Pickles: Salt pickle adds taste to food and enhances digestive ability. The method of preparation involves addition of salt to vegetable and fruit pieces and allowing it to soak.

b) Spiced Pickle: This type of pickle is tastier since oil and spices are added for

FSM_Theory_ch6.indd 82 20-02-2019 5.58.28 PM